

PRACTICAL PRAYERS

Forty prayers for the moments of the day — with Swamiji's sangha hymns

ELEVEN MOMENTS · FOUR PRAYERS EACH

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम्

BHAGAVAD GĪTĀ 4.24 — THE MEAL PRAYER

Why these prayers Swami Lakshmanjoo compiled his Wisdom verses in the summer of 1987 and told his devotees: "These verses are for your daily recitation. Maybe sometime you will experience these stages." Four of the six hymns in his recitation appendix live in these pages — the Krama Stotra, the Anuttarāṣṭikā, the Bhairava Stotra and the Dehastha — alongside the mealtime yajña he taught, the breath-japa of the Vijñāna Bhairava, and the dawn-dusk junction of the Tantrāloka: "the Lord must be worshipped at the point of the meeting of day and night." Eleven sections — one for each moment the day turns. Forty-four prayers, each facing its explanation — when to do it, how, why, and what it does. Nothing here needs belief. The verses were built to be said — at the sink, at the desk, in the queue, in the dark.

PRACTICAL PRAYERS

DECODING THE VERSES — THE AXIOMS (1 OF 2)

Śiva — consciousness that is *self-lit*: knowing that needs no second thing in order to be known.

Why: any knower requiring another knower regresses forever; the chain of proof must end in something self-evidencing. That self-evidencing is what the texts name Śiva. (svaprakāśa)

Śakti — Śiva knowing himself: power not as muscle but as the act of shining.

Why: "self-lit" means lit *by itself* — that "by" is Śakti. Flame and burning are one word's two halves.

Brahman (in the meal verse) — read as Śiva in all four places: offering, oblation, fire, goal.

Why: Gītā 4.24 names them all "brahman"; if any one differed, the chain would break into parts — one substance makes the meal a self-offering. (Lakshmanjoo, mealtime teaching)

So'ham / haṃsa — the mantra already running: out *sa*, in *ha*.

Why: Vijñāna Bhairava 155 — the jīva recites it 21,600 times a day without trying; so real practice adds no sound, it only shortens the gap (Swamiji's tuṭi-method) until you notice it.

Pañcākṣara — naḥ·maḥ·śi·vā·ya = the five acts: creation, preservation, dissolution, concealment, grace.

Why: nothing in experience falls outside those five — so five sounds cover the whole cycle, which is why one mantra can be the entire practice.

Anātha — the refuge that asks for no qualifications.

Why: a protector requiring worthy applicants is a merchant; "refuge of the refugeless" (Bhairavastava 1) removes the condition — grace that cannot be refused.

DECODING THE VERSES — THE AXIOMS (2 OF 2)

Anupāya — the no-means.

Why: if every method — contemplation, japa, visualization — can be dropped and recognition still arrives, method was never the cause. Anuttarāṣṭikā 1 simply lists what must be set down.

Pratyabhijñā — recognition, not achievement: you don't come to know Śiva; you notice you never stopped.

Why: bondage must be real for liberation to be sought — yet if it were real, no freedom could ever be felt; you do feel the difference, so bondage is a misreading, and what corrects a misreading is recognition.

Svātantrya — freedom: the cause that needs no cause.

Why: every chain of causation stops somewhere or loops; the texts place the stop at freedom — the one that acts without being acted on.

Pūjā — offering as re-cognition of what is already there.

Why: the litany (Mahopadeśaviṃśatikā 13–20) proves the Lord needs nothing from the rite — what the rite changes is the offerer. The worship is the worshipper, turning.

Bhakti — the method that is not a method.

Why: Śivastotrāvalī 1 describes a devotee attained without meditation or recitation — devotion works by alignment, not technique; that is why these guides give feelings, not repetitions.

Māyā — the world's making-power, seen from underneath.

Why: the texts never deny the world — "the world, both real and unreal" (Mahopadeśaviṃśatikā 11) — they deny only the view from below that takes the making for the made.

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I

Waking / Morning

on rising

Homage to the World-Formed

प्रपञ्चोत्तीर्णरूपाय नमस्ते विश्वमूर्तये । सदादिव्यप्रकाशाय स्वात्मनेऽनन्तशक्तये

prapañcottīrṇarūpāya namaste viśvamūrtaye | sadādivyaprakāśāya svātmane'nantaśaktaye

homage to the form that has crossed beyond the manifest — to the self of the world's form; to the ever-divinely-shining, to the self that is unending power.

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Homage to the World-Formed

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.1 · V.1

The first word of the day: bowing to what was here before you woke.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Three appositions do the work: he has passed beyond the manifest yet IS the world's form; he always shines with divine light; he is your own self and consists of inexhaustible power. The logic is identity, not distance — you salute the world-form because you address what already shines.

HOW TO USE IT

Sitting up before your feet touch the floor. Three clauses, three slow bows of the head. Feel the room as svātmane'nantaśaktaye — not out there but as your own body's brightness. Don't visualise a figure; visualise light that has nowhere to go. One round, then stand.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.1

The Body-Temple Offering

देहो देवालयः प्रोक्तः स्वात्मा देवः सनातनः । त्यजेदज्ञाननिर्माल्यं सोऽहं भावेन पूजयेत्

deho devālayaḥ proktaḥ svātmā devaḥ sanātanaḥ | tyajedajñānanirmālyaṃ so'haṃ bhāvena pūjayet

the body is declared god's temple, the own self the eternal god. casting off the sweepings of ignorance, let him worship with the feeling: i-am-he.

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The Body-Temple Offering

DEHASTHA V.1 · V.1

The morning rite in one verse: the body is the shrine, so'ham is the worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Dehastha compresses a whole pūjā into four clauses. Temple, God, sweeping, worship: a temple needs cleaning before its God is honoured, and the 'sweepings of ignorance' are the ordinary assumption that the body is mere matter. The worshipper and the worshipped collapse — so'ham bhāvena, with the feeling I-am-He.

HOW TO USE IT

Wake and stay horizontal. Sweep an imaginary hand from head to toe three times — that is casting off the sweepings. Then place attention at the heart and let so'haṃ, so'haṃ rest with the breath for twelve rounds. The feeling: warmth at the chest, not a thought — the body as lit. Then rise: the day is the pūjā.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.1

The Three States as His Rays

जाग्रतस्वप्नसुषुप्त्याद्या धारयंश्च निजाः कलाः ।
स्वेच्छया भासि नटवन् निष्कलोऽसि च
तत्त्वतः

jāgratasvapnasuṣuptyādyā dhārayaṃśca nijāḥ kalāḥ | svecchayā bhāsi naṭavan niṣkalo'si ca tattvataḥ

waking, dreaming, deep sleep and the rest — you hold them as your own portions. By your will you shine like an actor, yet you are partless in truth.

3

The Three States as His Rays

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.10 · V.10

The three states are costumes; the one who shines is partless.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse splits experience from experiencer: the states are kalāḥ, portions or costumes — things held; the holding is by svecchā, your own will; and the actor is partless though he plays many parts. Play and partlessness are asserted in one breath, so no state can claim you.

HOW TO USE IT

Recite on waking, naming each state as you come out of it: 'that was a costume.' The actor-idea is literal — you played sleep for seven hours. Feel the partlessness as the fact that nothing about you has edges. Keep it memorised: the fastest exit from a bad dream.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.10

The Play of the Dawning

उदयावभासचर्वणलीलां विश्वस्य या करोत्यनिशम्। आनन्दभैरवीं तां विमर्शरूपामहं वन्दे

udayāvabhāsacarvaṇalīlāṃ viśvasya yā karotyaniśam | ānandabhairavīṃ tāṃ vimarśarūpāmahaṃ vande

the play of the dawning, shining forth, and chewing over of the universe, which she performs unceasingly — bliss-bhairavī, her, whose form is reflection, i praise.

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The Play of the Dawning

DEHASTHA V.6 · V.6

The dawn is her play: she chews the universe into light, unceasingly.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Bhairavī's līlā is udaya-avabhāsa-carvaṇa — the dawning, shining and chewing of the universe, performed without pause; her form is vimarśa, reflective awareness. The morning light is not physics but her appetite: she is already chewing the day into being when you open your eyes.

HOW TO USE IT

At first light, before anything else: watch the room brighten and name it her chewing. One line. Feeling-tip: the day is being eaten into existence for you; you arrive mid-meal. Gratitude, not effort.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.6



II

Bathing

water & body

What Bath for the Stainless?

निर्मलस्य कुतः स्नानं वस्त्रं विश्वोदरस्य च। निर्लेपस्य कुतो गन्धो रम्यस्याभरणं कुतः

nirmalasya kutaḥ snānaṃ vastraṃ viśvodarasya ca | nirlepasya kuto gandho ramyasyābharaṇaṃ kutaḥ

for the stainless, what bath? for the world-bellied, what garment? for the unanointed, what scent? for the lovely, what jewel?

What Bath for the Stainless?

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.14 · V.14

Shower, towel, scent, jewel — all addressed to one who needs none.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The litany names the bathroom itself: snāna (bath), vastra (garment), gandha (scent), bharaṇa (jewel) — each with a deity stripped of the lack it serves: stainless, world-bellied (all-containing), unanointed, lovely. What looks like futility is the precise applicability of each gift: you bathe the unblemished because bathing is what love does, not what dirt requires.

HOW TO USE IT

In the shower: name each item as you use it — water for the stainless, towel for the world-bellied, scent for the unanointed. The mismatch is the smile. Feeling-tip: the water becomes an offering rather than a chore; three items, three small bows.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.14

This Body for Worship

अन्तरुल्लसदच्छाच्छभक्तिपीयूषपोषितम् / भवत्पूजोपयोगाय शरीरम् इदम् अस्तु मे

antarullasadacchācchabhaktipīyūṣapoṣitam / bhavatpūjopayogāya śarīram idam astu me

may this body of mine — nourished by the clear, bright nectar of devotion rising within — be fit only for your worship.

This Body for Worship

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.26 · 17.26

The body leaves the water consecrated: today's uniform is worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The body is not renounced; it is consecrated. Nourished by the clear nectar of devotion rising in the heart (antar ullasad acchāccha-bhakti-pīyūṣa), it becomes fit for pūjā — and then it is the offering itself. This is the Trika answer to body-denial: the body is the Lord's instrument, and devotion makes it luminous.

HOW TO USE IT

Dressed, before leaving the bathroom: say it once and feel the freshly washed body as anointed rather than merely clean. The day ahead is the pūjā; the body is the instrument. Feeling-tip: a slight uprightness in the spine — the instrument picking itself up.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.26

Waving-Lights for the Self-Shining

स्वयं प्रकाशमानस्य कुतो नीराजनं विभोः । वेदवाचामवेद्यस्य कुतः स्तोत्रं विधीयते

svayaṃ prakāśamānasya kuto nīrājanaṃ vibhoḥ | vedavācāmavedyasya kutaḥ stotraṃ vidhīyate

whence waving-lights for the self-shining lord? how is a hymn enjoined for him whom the veda cannot say?

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Waving-Lights for the Self-Shining

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.17 · V.17

The mirror, the lamp: he lights himself — so the light is for you.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Two paradoxes: an offering of light presupposes darkness in the recipient; speech presupposes an object speech can reach. The Lord is self-lit and beyond the Veda's words. The rite's use falls on the offerer — you wave the lamp so your own eyes open; you sing because the singing lights you.

HOW TO USE IT

At the bathroom mirror, hand raised with the light: you are the lamp-bearer, and the face that brightens is the audience. Hum, don't articulate — you have just honoured the Vedavācāmavedya. Feeling-tip: the chest brightens before the mirror does.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.17

Pardon for the Unseen

पूर्णस्य दक्षिणा कुत्र नित्यतृप्तस्य तर्पणम्। विसर्जनं व्यापकस्याऽप्रत्यक्षस्य क्षमापणम्

pūrṇasya dakṣiṇā kutra nityatṛptasya tarpaṇam | visarjanaṃ vyāpakasyā'pratyakṣasya kṣamāpaṇam

where is the fee for the full? libation for the ever-content? dismissal for the all-pervading? pardon for the unseen?

Pardon for the Unseen

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.19 · V.19

The ritual closes with forgiveness — and no account to settle.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The four closing rites: dakṣiṇā (fee), tarpaṇa (libation), visarjana (dismissal), kṣamāpaṇa (apology for faults) — all presuppose want, debt, departure and fault in one who is full, content, all-pervading and unseen. The kṣamāpaṇa for the apratyakṣa flips apology into recognition: you apologise to what was never absent.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it at the end of the bath as the day's closing already: one bow, weight the last word — pardon. The feeling is the end of accounting: no tally of errors, no debt. Guilt arrives, is named as one of the litany's items, and dissolves with the god it expected to offend.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.19



III

Social

out among people

The Speech-Goddess

स्वात्मप्रभां विधाय वाग्देवीं विषयकुसुमकॢप्तार्चः । प्रथमोन्मेषं गुरुम् अथ वन्दित्वा हृदयम् आविश्य

svātmaprabhāṃ vidhāya vāgdevīṃ viṣayakusumakḷptārcaḥ | prathamonmeṣaṃ gurum atha vanditvā hṛdayam āviśya

having made the speech-goddess one's own light, with sense-flowers arranged as offering — bowing to the guru, first unfolding, then entering the heart.

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The Speech-Goddess

BHAIRAVĀNUKARAṆA V.7 · BHAIR-P01 V.7

Before you speak: make vāk the light, not the weapon.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse sequences the art of speech: svātmaprabhāṃ vidhāya vāgdevīṃ — make the speech-goddess your own light; arrange the sense-flowers as the offering; bow to the guru, the first unfolding (prathamonmeṣa); then enter the heart. Speech is not emitted from the mouth but lit from the heart and offered with the senses.

HOW TO USE IT

Before a difficult conversation, a speech, a message you'll regret: one breath, hand on the throat. Make the speech a light — not a blade. Offering the sense-flowers means: don't weaponise what you've seen and heard. Then speak from the heart-entered place, not the throat.

Source: bhairavanukarana.md · bhair-p01 v.7

Every Sound Is Mantra

शब्दः कश्चन यो मुखादुदयते मन्त्रः स लोकोत्तरः संस्थानं सुखदुःखजन्मवपुषो यत्कापि मुद्रैव सा । प्राणस्य स्वरसेन यत्प्रवहणं योगः स एवाद्भुतः शाक्तं धाम परं ममानुभवतः किन्नाम न भ्राजते

śabdaḥ kaścana yo mukhādudayate mantraḥ sa lokottaraḥ saṃsthānaṃ sukhaduḥkhajanmavapuṣo yatkāpi mudraiva sā | prāṇasya svarasena yatpravahaṇaṃ yogaḥ sa evādbhutaḥ śāktaṃ dhāma paraṃ mamānubhavataḥ kinnāma na bhrājate

whatever sound arises from the mouth — that mantra is transcendent. whatever posture of the pleasure-pain-born body — that indeed is mudrā. whatever flowing of breath by its own rhythm — that indeed is wonderful yoga. the supreme śākta abode — while i experience, what indeed would not shine?

Every Sound Is Mantra

ANUBHAVANIVEDANA V.3 · ANU-P03 V.3

Every word out of your mouth is already a mantra. Use that.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Abhinavagupta's experience-report: any sound from the mouth is lokottara mantra — transcendent; any posture is mudrā; any breath-flow by its own rhythm is yoga. Nothing needs to be Sanskritic to be practice. The verse abolishes the distinction between talking and chanting, fidgeting and ritual, breathing and kriyā.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it after you've said something — ordinary, even stupid. That was mantra. The recognition flips the whole day: the meeting, the small talk, the complaint — all of it is mantra, mudrā, yoga, shining. Feeling-tip: the mouth becomes a temple; be careful what you put on the altar.

Source: anubhavanivedana.md · anu-p03 v.3

Enough of Difference-Talk

अलं भेदानुकथया त्वद्भक्तिरसचर्वणात्। सर्वमेकमिदं शान्तमिति वक्तुं च लज्जते

alaṃ bhedānukathayā tvadbhaktirasacarvaṇāt | sarvamekamidaṃ śāntamiti vaktuṃ ca lajjate

enough of difference-talk — chewing the sap of devotion to you: all this is one, at peace; and even to say so feels shy.

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Enough of Difference-Talk

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.8 · V.8

Knowing when to stop talking: the oneness embarrasses speech.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Bheda-anukathā, the narration of difference, is abandoned mid-chewing of bhakti-rasa: all is one, at peace. And even to say so feels shy (lajjate) — the verse guards non-duality from becoming a thesis. The oneness is so ordinary that stating it out loud is like announcing a family is at peace: true, and slightly vulgar.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it when an argument about views has you mid-sentence — or when you're about to explain your practice to someone who doesn't need it. Stop. The shyness is the right register. Feeling-tip: looking away slightly, a small heat in the face — let the body do the disarming.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.8

When Your Words Are Not Heard

ब्रूषे नोत्तमाङ्ग पश्यसि न मामेतादृशं दुःखितं विज्ञप्तिं
बहुधा कृतां न शृणुषे नायासि मन्मानसे ।
संसारार्णवगर्तमध्यपतितं प्रायेण नालम्बसे
वाक्चक्षुःश्रवणाङ्घ्रिणादिरहितं त्वामाह सत्यं श्रुतिः

brūṣe nottamāṅga paśyasi na māmetādṛśaṃ duḥkhitaṃ vijñaptiṃ bahudhā kṛtāṃ na śṛṇuṣe nāyāsi manmānase |
saṃsārārṇavagartamadhyapatitaṃ prāyeṇa nālambase vākcakṣuḥśravaṇāṅghriṇādirahitaṃ tvāmāha satyaṃ śrutiḥ

you speak not, o best-limbed one; you look not upon me, wretched as i am. my entreaty, made in many ways, you hear not; you come not into my mind. fallen amid the pit of the ocean of transmigration, i am mostly left unsupported — yet scripture truly declares you devoid of speech, sight, hearing, feet and the like!

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When Your Words Are Not Heard

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 3 · PAN-P03

The complaint: you don't speak, look or hear — and scripture says you can't. Ouch.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Pañcaślokī 3 is the reproach: the devotee accuses Śiva of silence — no speech, no glance, no listening, no arrival in the mind — then undercuts himself with scripture's own claim that the Lord is devoid of speech, sight, hearing and feet. The complaint and the theology cancel: you're angry at a god who, by definition, never had a mouth to answer with.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it when you've spoken and nobody heard — human or divine. Say the whole complaint with feeling; the scripture-clause at the end is the punchline that dissolves it. Feeling-tip: the irritation turns to laughter mid-verse; that laugh is the prasāda.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p03



IV

At Work

at the desk

Yoke the Mind

एवमेव परा पूजा सर्वावस्थासु सर्वदा। ऐक्यबुद्धया तु सर्वेशे मनो देवे नियोजयेत्

evameva parā pūjā sarvāvasthāsu sarvadā | aikyabuddhayā tu sarveśe mano deve niyojayet

just so is the highest worship — in every state, at all times: with a mind of oneness, one should yoke the mind to god as the lord of all.

Yoke the Mind

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.20 · V.20

The instruction after the litany: work is the highest pūjā.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Parā pūjā is ritual re-specified: all states, all times instead of the fixed occasion, and aikyabuddhi — oneness-mindedness — instead of the duality of giver and gift. The verb is niyojayet, yoke: the mind is a draught-animal that must be hitched, and the yoke is identity. The desk becomes the temple by the hitching, not the décor.

HOW TO USE IT

Before opening the laptop: one line, then begin. The test for aikyabuddhi: the boundary of your skin thins. If it sharpens, you're thinking oneness, not yoking it — drop to the breath and restart. Each task is one yoke; re-hitch as often as needed.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.20

Achieve God in Activity

शिवो भूत्वा यजेतेति भक्तो भूत्वेति कथ्यते / त्वम् एव हि वपुः सारं भक्तैर् अद्वयशोधितम्

śivo bhūtvā yajeteti bhakto bhūtveti kathyate / tvam eva hi vapuḥ sāraṃ bhaktair advayaśodhitam

so the devotee is told: become śiva and worship. you yourself are the essence of the body, purified by devotion's non-duality.

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Achieve God in Activity

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.14 · 1.14

Lakshmanjoo's work verse: find God in the activity, not by shunning it.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse (śivo bhūtvā yajeti) instructs: become Śiva and worship — and adds that the body's essence (vapuḥ sāraṃ) is refined by bhakti's advaya, non-duality. The gloss from the Academy: achieve God in the activity of the universe, not by shunning it; perceive him in each and every action of life. Work is the field, not the obstacle.

HOW TO USE IT

At the desk, when work feels like a distraction from practice: say it and reclassify. The spreadsheet, the email, the conversation — that is the worship. Feeling-tip: the task itself becomes slightly luminous; do it as offering, not as interruption.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.14

I-Making Flowers

कुरुते भैरवपूजामनलदलस्थाऽभिमानकुसुमैर्या । नित्यमहङ्कृतिरूपां वन्दे तां शाम्भवीमम्बाम्

kurute bhairavapūjāmanaladalasthā'bhimānakusumairyā | nityamahaṅkṛtirūpāṃ vande tāṃ śāmbhavīmambām

who performs bhairava's worship, standing in fire's petal, with flowers of i-making — ever of i-making form, i praise her, the mother śāmbhavī.

THE GUIDE

I-Making Flowers

DEHASTHA V.8 · V.8

Hand the work-ego over: the ahaṃkāra is the offering.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Śāmbhavī stands in the petal of fire and worships with abhimāna-kusuma — flowers of I-making: the sense of mine and I that is normally the problem. The rite converts the fault into the flower. At work, the 'I' that wants credit is not suppressed — it is picked and placed in the fire.

HOW TO USE IT

When the ego flares mid-task — pride, irritation at the colleague, hunger for recognition: see it as a flower, pick it, place it at the heart's fire. Three flowers are enough. Feeling-tip: relief, like putting down a bag; the fire (warmth at the solar plexus) confirms it.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.8

When Your Form Expands

त्वत्स्वरूपे जृम्भमाणे त्वं चाहं चाखिलं जगत्। जाते तस्य तिरोधाने न त्वं नाहं न वै जगत्

tvatsvarūpe jṛmbhamāṇe tvaṃ cāhaṃ cākhilaṃ jagat | jāte tasya tirodhāne na tvaṃ nāhaṃ na vai jagat

when your own form expands — you and i and the whole world. when its withdrawal is born — neither you, nor i, nor indeed the world.

When Your Form Expands

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.9 · V.9

Expansion and withdrawal: the world is his inhale and exhale.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Two movements: when svarūpa expands (jṛmbhamāṇe), you, I and the whole world appear together; when it withdraws (tirodhāne), none of the three remains. The verse relativises the entire workday — deadlines, colleagues, the self doing them — as one expansion of his form. Not nihilism: the expansion is real, and so is who expands it.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it at the overwhelm point — too much to do, the self tightening. Say it and feel the day as one exhale of a larger form. The overwhelm thins because the 'me' carrying it is part of the expansion, not its owner. Then return to the next small task.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.9



V

Food

before eating

The Meal Offering

ब्रह्मार्पणं ब्रह्म हविर् ब्रह्माग्नौ ब्रह्मणा हुतम् ।
ब्रह्मैव तेन गन्तव्यं ब्रह्मकर्मसमाधिना ॥

brahmārpaṇaṁ brahma havir brahmāgnau brahmaṇā hutam | brahmaiva tena gantavyaṁ brahmakarmasamādhinā ||

the offering is brahman / the oblation is brahman / poured by brahman into the fire of brahman / brahman alone is reached / by one absorbed in the action that is brahman

The Meal Offering

BHAGAVAD GĪTĀ 4.24 (LAKSHMANJOO MEALTIME YAJÑA) · GĪTĀ 4.24

The meal prayer: water in the palm, one verse, and eating becomes worship.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Lakshmanjoo read brahman throughout as Lord Śiva. Four things are named — the offering, the oblation, the fire, the goal — and all four are the same substance. What you take is offered to Śiva; what you offer is itself Śiva; the stomach is Śiva's residence. The logic collapses the distance between eater, food and eaten into one taste.

HOW TO USE IT

Before the first bite: put a little water in the palm, look at the food, and say the verse once. Then eat as if the meal is being offered into a fire — slowly, without hurry. The feeling to find: gratitude with heat. Nothing extra; the verse does the whole work.

Source: mealtime-yajna.md · Gītā 4.24

Śiva Bows to Śiva

अस्मद्रूप समाविष्टः स्वात्मनात्म निवारणे । शिवः करोतु निजया नमः शक्त्या ततात्मने ॥

asmadrūpa samāviṣṭaḥ svātmanātma nivāraṇe | śivaḥ karotu nijayā namaḥ śaktyā tatātmane ‖

śiva, having entered the form that is myself, bows — by his own power — to śiva, for the removal of the obstacle that is himself.

Śiva Bows to Śiva

SOMANANDA, ŚIVADṚṢṬI 7.103 (MEALTIME LORE) · ŚIVADṚṢṬI 7.103 (PROVISIONAL)

The obstacle on the plate is also Śiva. Say it before food.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The whole Trika in one bow: the one who bows, the one bowed to, the obstacle being removed, and the power doing the removing are all Śiva. Nothing is outside the recognition — not even the thing that blocks it. Lakshmanjoo taught this verse alongside the mealtime practice.

HOW TO USE IT

Say it silently as the food arrives. The 'obstacle' can be anything — the craving, the guilt, the person you're eating with. Name it, then let the verse dissolve it. Feeling-tip: the moment of placing should feel like relief, like putting something down.

Source: mealtime-yajna.md · Śivadṛṣṭi 7.103 (provisional)

The Sense-Goddesses Offer Bhairava

आत्मीयविषयभोगैरिन्द्रियदेव्यः सदा हृदम्भोजे। अभिपूजयन्ति यं तं चिन्मयमानन्दभैरवं वन्दे

ātmīyaviṣayabhogairindriyadevyaḥ sadā hṛdambhoje | abhipūjayanti yaṃ taṃ cinmayamānandabhairavaṃ vande

with feasts of their own sense-objects, the sense-goddesses ever worship, in the heart-lotus, him — the consciousness-made bliss-bhairava: i praise.

The Sense-Goddesses Offer Bhairava

DEHASTHA V.5 · V.5

Every taste is already a pūjā happening in the heart.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Dehastha inverts the usual charge against the senses: the senses are goddesses (indriya-devyāḥ), and their enjoyment of their objects is continuous worship of the Bhairava made of consciousness. Eating is the oldest form of practice — the offering is already being made in the heart-lotus.

HOW TO USE IT

At the first bite, feel the heart-lotus (just behind the centre of the chest) as the altar and the flavour as the flower landing on it. Three bites only — overdoing it kills the taste. The feeling: gratitude with heat. The sense is honoured as a goddess, not supervised as a thief.

Source: deha-p01.md · v.5

Devouring Māyā as Food

मायीयकालनियतिरागाद्याहारतर्पिताः / चरन्ति सुखिनो नाथ भक्तिमन्तो जगत्तटे

māyīyakālaniyatirāgādyāhāratarpitāḥ / caranti sukhino nātha bhaktimanto jagattaṭe

o nātha, your devotees roam happy on the shore of the world, filled and satisfied by consuming māyā, time, fate and desire themselves.

Devouring Māyā as Food

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 15.2 · 15.2

The devotee's menu: māyā, time, niyati, desire — eaten for breakfast.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse is a mealtime paradox: the devotees are tarpitāḥ, sated, by consuming māyīya, kāla, niyati, rāgādi — the very forces that starve everyone else. What the world treats as hunger (desire, fate, time) is their food. They roam happy on the shore of the world, having eaten the ocean.

HOW TO USE IT

Before or after a meal, when desire is loudest: name it as the course — māyā, time, fate, desire — and eat it. The hunger is the menu. Feeling-tip: the wanting transforms into satedness mid-sentence; that flip is the verse working.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 15.2



VI

Waiting

in the in-between

I Don't Mind

विषमस्थो ऽपि स्वस्थो ऽपि रुदन्न् अपि हसन्न् अपि / गम्भीरो ऽपि विचित्तो ऽपि भवेयं भक्तितः प्रभो

viṣamastho 'pi svastho 'pi rudann api hasann api / gambhīro 'pi vicitto 'pi bhaveyaṃ bhaktitaḥ prabho

in crisis or at ease, weeping or laughing, grave or unhinged — by devotion, lord, let me be so.

I Don't Mind

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.8 · 16.8

The api-chain refuses resolution: everything is allowed.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse piles up opposites with 'api' (even): viṣama/sthāna (crisis/peace), rudann/hasann (weeping/laughing), gambhīro/vicitta (grave/unhinged). Devotion is not the absence of any of them; it is what holds them. The prayer does not ask for calm — it asks to be devotion through whatever arrives.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it when waiting has turned into agitation — a queue, a delay, a message that won't come. Say it once inwardly. Don't wait for composure: the very mess is the place where devotion can be. Feeling-tip: the shoulders drop half a millimetre; that's the api doing its work.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.8

In Every Action

अनुभूयासमीशान प्रतिकर्म क्षणात् क्षणम् /
भवत्पूजामृतापानमदास्वादमहामुदम्

anubhūyāsamīśāna pratikarma kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam / bhavatpūjāmṛtāpānamadāsvādamahāmudam

o lord, may i experience, moment by moment, in every action, the great joy of drinking the nectar of your worship.

In Every Action

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.19 · 17.19

The in-between moment becomes the practice itself.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Utpaladeva prays for the taste of worship inside every action — not more ritual, but the nectar of pūjā in the ordinary. 'Moment by moment' (kṣaṇāt kṣaṇam) is the whole method: the repeated return of attention. Waiting is full of kṣaṇas — this verse makes them the site of the drink.

HOW TO USE IT

At any transition or pause: say it once, then take one breath as if that breath were the nectar. Don't manufacture joy — notice the small lift that a pause already gives. Three pauses, three sips, and the waiting has changed colour.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.19

Abandon Nothing, Grasp Nothing

संसारो ऽस्ति न तत्त्वतस् तनुभृतां बन्धस्य वार्तैव का
बन्धो यस्य न जातु तस्य वितथा मुक्तस्य मुक्तिक्रिया ।
मिथ्यामोहकृद् एष रज्जुभुजगच्छायापिशाचभ्रमो मा
किंचित् त्यज मा गृहाण विहर स्वस्थो यथावस्थितः

saṃsāro 'sti na tattvatas tanubhṛtāṃ bandhasya vārtaiva kā bandho yasya na jātu tasya vitathā muktasya muktikriyā | mithyāmohakṛd eṣa rajjubhujagacchāyāpiśācabhramo mā kiṃcit tyaja mā gṛhāṇa vihara svastho yathāvasthitaḥ

saṃsāra is not, in truth, for body-holders — of bondage, what news? bondage never truly is for anyone — so for the free, liberation-rite is false. this error-maker is rope-snake-shadow-ghost-delusion. abandon nothing; grasp nothing; live healthy, staying as you are.

THE GUIDE

Abandon Nothing, Grasp Nothing

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.2 · ANU-P02 V.2

The waiting instruction par excellence: don't add, don't subtract, just stay.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse dismantles bondage itself — saṃsāra never truly was; the bondage-story is the rope-snake-shadow ghost of māyā. Then the instruction in four beats: mā kiṃcit tyaja (abandon nothing), mā gṛhāṇa (grasp nothing), vihara (live), svastho yathāvasthitaḥ (stay as you are). Waiting is where the mind most wants to add or subtract.

HOW TO USE IT

In the queue, the delay, the silence: say the last line — 'live healthy, staying as you are.' The restlessness wants to grab something or drop something; the verse forbids both. Feeling-tip: the hands open and close once, then rest; the waiting is now the living.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p02 v.2

Two Classes of People

न किञ्चिद् एव लोकानां भवदावरणं प्रति यत् किं चिद् एव भूतानां

na kiñcid eva lokānāṃ bhavadāvaraṇaṃ prati yat kiṃ cid eva bhūtānāṃ

there are two classes found in this universe: one class is of ordinary people, and another are those who are thy devotees.

Two Classes of People

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.1 · 16.1

In the queue: two kinds of people, and you know which you are.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse is a quiet census — only two classes, ordinary folk and bhaktas — with no third category of the merely interested. It's a wry re-classification of the crowd: everyone waiting with you belongs to one of two groups, and the difference isn't visible from the outside. The devotee smiles at the census.

HOW TO USE IT

Use it in any crowd — the queue, the train, the meeting. Run the census once: two classes. Then check which one is noticing the census. Feeling-tip: a small private smile; nobody can tell from the outside which class you're in — that's the point.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.1



VII

When You Are Sick

illness · pain

No Fear-Talk

स्वात्मनि विश्वगये त्वयि नाथे तेन न संसृतिभीतिकथास्ति । सत्स्व् अपि दुर्धरदुःखविमोहत्रासविधायिषु कर्मगणेषु

svātmani viśvagaye tvayi nāthe tena na saṃsṛtibhītikathāsti | satsv api durdharaduḥkhavimohatrāsavidhāyiṣu karmagaṇeṣu

with you as lord, all-pervading in own self — therefore no talk of transmigration-fear. even though hard-to-bear suffering, delusion, terror-causing karma-hosts are present.

No Fear-Talk

ABHINAVAGUPTA, BHAIRAVASTAVA 3 · BH-P03

The suffering is conceded; the fear-talk is not.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse does not deny suffering — it concedes the karma-hosts (durdharaduḥkhavimohatrāsavidhāyiṣu) — but denies the fear of saṃsāra, because the Lord is all-pervading in the self. Suffering can be present without being feared; the fear-talk is what stops.

HOW TO USE IT

When negative, say it and let the concession stand: yes, this is hard; and the fear of it is separate from the pain itself. The verse splits them. Feeling-tip: the pain stays, the story about the pain thins. That thinning is the verse working.

Source: bhairavastava.md · bh-p03

Forgetting, and the Final Plea

यातस्त्वत्सहवासतो बहुतरः कालो वतास्मिन् क्षणे किं किं वा न कृतं त्वया वरगुरूपासानिमित्तेन मे । वारं वारमहं पुनर्निरुपमां दिव्यं भुवं प्रासुवत्कायस्त्वां किल विस्मरामि यदतः स्थेयं न भूयस्त्वया

yātastvatsahavāsato bahutaraḥ kālo vatāsmin kṣaṇe kiṃ kiṃ vā na kṛtaṃ tvayā varagurūpāsānimittena me | vāraṃ vāramahaṃ punarnirupamāṃ divyaṃ bhuvaṃ prāsuvatkāyastvāṃ kila vismarāmi yadataḥ stheyaṃ na bhūyastvayā

much time dwelling with you has passed — alas, in this very moment! what, what has not been done by you for me, for the sake of serving the excellent guru! again and again i, whose body has attained the incomparable divine plane — yet indeed i forget you. therefore, by you let there be no further staying-away!

Forgetting, and the Final Plea

ABHINAVAGUPTA, PAÑCAŚLOKĪ 5 · PAN-P05

The illness plea: you've done everything for me — so don't stay away now.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Pañcaślokī 5 turns on time and forgetting: much time has passed with him; nothing has not been done for you; and still you forget him. The plea — let there be no further staying-away — is asked not from desert but from a record of grace: you owe nothing, he has paid everything, so his absence now would be the only unkindness left.

HOW TO USE IT

When ill and feeling forgotten: say the whole verse as the complaint it is — 'what has not been done by you for me?' — and let the last line be the request. Feeling-tip: the forgetting is admitted first (you forgot him); the plea is fair because of that. One round, then rest.

Source: pancashloki.md · pan-p05

Dance with the Foot-Dust

भवत्पादाम्बुजरजोराजिरञ्जितमूर्धजः / अपाररभसारब्धनर्तनः स्याम् अहं कदा

bhavatpādāmbujarajorājirañjitamūrdhajaḥ / apārarabhasārabdhanartanaḥ syām ahaṃ kadā

when will that glorious day come to me, my lord — your lotus-foot dust anointing my hair — that i may dance the dance begun from the endless?

Dance with the Foot-Dust

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 5.2 · 5.2

For the sickbed: the day I dance with your foot-dust on my head.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse is pure longing — kadā, when: when will my hair be rubbed with the dust of your lotus feet, and I dance a dance begun from the boundless? The foot-dust is the classical sign of total surrender — the head as the lowest place, the master's foot as the highest — and the dance is what follows: not recovery as return to normal, but entry into a dance that starts at the infinite.

HOW TO USE IT

From the sickbed, say it as a question — kadā, when — without demanding the answer today. Picture only the dust on the hair; the dance can wait. Feeling-tip: longing itself becomes the posture; the verse sanctifies not-yet.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 5.2

Whatever Is Seen Is You

अन्तर्देहे मया नित्यं त्वमात्मा च गवेषितः । न दृष्टस्त्वं नचैवात्मा यच्च दृष्टं त्वमेव तत्

antardehe mayā nityaṃ tvamātmā ca gaveṣitaḥ | na dṛṣṭastvaṃ nacaivātmā yacca dṛṣṭaṃ tvameva tat

inside the body, sought by me always — you as self, and the self is never seen.
whatever is seen is you alone, that.

Whatever Is Seen Is You

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.3 · V.3

When the body hurts: whatever is seen — even this — is you.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse performs a swap: I search for you inside the body as the self, and the self is never seen — but whatever IS seen, tvameva tat, is you alone. Applied to illness: the pain, the weakness, the scanned body — none of it is the self, and all of it is him. The sick body becomes the visible half of an invisible lord.

HOW TO USE IT

When pain or weakness is present: look at it once — the ache as an object — and name it 'seen: you.' Not as denial of pain but as address change. Feeling-tip: the pain stays but loses its claim to be yours; it's his visible side, and visibility is already grace.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.3



VIII

Alone

solitude · loneliness

You Alone Are You

त्वं त्वमेवाहमेवाहं त्वमेवासि न चास्म्यहम्। अहं त्वमित्युभौ न स्तो यत्र तस्मै नमो नमः

tvaṃ tvamevāhamevāhaṃ tvamevāsi na cāsmyaham | ahaṃ tvamityubhau na sto yatra tasmai namo namaḥ

you alone are you; i alone am i. you alone are; i am not at all.
as for you and me both being —
where is there homage, homage?

You Alone Are You

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.2 · V.2

The riddle of two: there is no pair, so no greeting.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse dissolves company at the root: tvam eva (you alone), aham eva (i alone) — and the 'both' (ubhau) is denied outright, so where is namas between two? Loneliness is not a lack here; it is the arithmetic. The verse exists anyway, which is the joke.

HOW TO USE IT

When loneliness bites: run the arithmetic aloud — there is no second to be missing. Feeling-tip: the ache of missing-people turns into the oddness of the riddle; company was the phrasing error.

Source: L2-mpa-p01.md · v.2

Refuge of the Refugeless

न ध्यायतो न जपतः स्याद् यस्याविधिपूर्वकम् / एवम् एव शिवभासस् तं नुमो भक्तिशालिनम्

na dhyāyato na japataḥ syād yasyāvidhipūrvakam / evam eva śivabhāsas taṃ numo bhaktiśālinam

pervading every state of moving and unmoving,
consciousness itself is one — without end or beginning.
bhairava, lord, refuge of the helpless —
with a mind become yours, in my heart, i bow.

Refuge of the Refugeless

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 1.1 · 1.1

The address for when there is no one else.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Anātha-śaraṇya — refuge of the one WITHOUT a protector — is the name at the heart of being alone: he shelters precisely those who bring no credentials, no community, nobody standing behind them. The verse is the door that opens when every other door has closed.

HOW TO USE IT

When the room is too quiet: say it and give the loneliness its address — it qualifies you rather than disqualifies you. Feeling-tip: the absence of people becomes the presence of the one who takes the unprotected.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 1.1

The Caves of Embrace

संसारसदसो बाह्ये कैश् चित्त्वं परिरभ्यसे /
स्वामिन् परैस् तु तत्रैव ताम्यद्भिस्
त्यक्तयन्त्रणैः

saṃsārasadaso bāhye kaiś cittvaṃ parirabhyase / svāmin parais tu tatraiva tāmyadbhis tyaktayantraṇaiḥ

outside the assembly of the world, by some —
o master, you are embraced; there, by those
who have let go of every entanglement.

The Caves of Embrace

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 16.28 · 16.28

The ones who leave the assembly to embrace him in caves.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse locates devotion off-grid: bāhye — outside the worldly sadas, the assembly — you are embraced by some, and the condition is tyaktayantraṇa, every entanglement dropped. Solitude is not exile here but the venue: the cave is where the meeting is scheduled.

HOW TO USE IT

When being alone feels like exclusion: say it and re-label — you are outside the assembly, which is where the embrace happens. Feeling-tip: solitude converts from exile to address.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 16.28

The Unique One

नमः सततबद्धाय
नित्यनिर्मुक्तिभागिने /
बन्धमोक्षविहीनाय कस्मै चि द् अपि
शम्भवे

namaḥ satatabaddhāya nityanirmuktibhāgine / bandhamokṣavihīnāya kasmai ci d api śambhave

namas to the unique śambhu — always bound,
yet forever free; beyond both bondage and liberation —
to no one else whatever.

The Unique One

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.17 · 2.17

Beyond both bondage and freedom: the total singularity.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Kasmai cid api — 'to whoever else there might be': there is no second. Śiva is simultaneously baddha and nirmukta, bound and free, and then declared beyond the pair altogether. The aloneness of the unique is total — and cheerful, because even liberation was dropped as a two-sided word.

HOW TO USE IT

Alone at night: say it and notice there was never a second in the first place. Feeling-tip: the singularity stops being isolation and starts being sovereignty.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.17

IX

Flatness

boredom · blankness

Things Are Consciousness-Form

रागद्वेषसुखासुखोदयलयाहङ्कारदैन्यादयो ये भावाः
प्रविभान्ति विश्ववपुषो भिन्नस्वभावा न ते । व्यक्तिं पश्यसि
यस्य यस्य सहसा तत्तत्तदेकात्मतासंविद्रूपम् अवेक्ष्य किं न
रमसे तद्भावनानिर्भरः

rāgadveṣasukhāsukhodayalayāhaṅkāradainyādayo ye bhāvāḥ pravibhānti viśvavapuṣo bhinnasvabhāvā na te | vyaktiṃ paśyasi yasya yasya sahasā tattattadekātmatāsaṃvidrūpam avekṣya kiṃ na ramase tadbhāvanānirbharaḥ

passion, aversion, pleasure, displeasure, rise and fall, i-ness, misery and the rest — things shining forth, universe-bodied, are not different-natured. whosever manifestation you suddenly see — having regarded it as one-self-natured consciousness-form — why do you not delight, full of contemplation?

Things Are Consciousness-Form

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.5 · ANU-P05 V.5

Everything that arrives is consciousness-form: so why not delight?

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse lists what a waiting mind churns through — rāga, dveṣa, sukha, aśukha, rise, fall, ahaṃkāra, misery — and denies them separate nature: they are viśva-vapuṣa, bodying the universe, shining as one-self-natured consciousness-form. The instruction is ramase: delight, full of that contemplation. Boredom is a failure of seeing, not of circumstance.

HOW TO USE IT

When the waiting mind churns: pick whatever is arising — irritation, boredom — and label it 'consciousness-form.' Then the verse's question stands: why not delight? Feeling-tip: the irritation, seen as form, is already interesting; delight arrives sideways.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p05 v.5

Enter Wherever Thought Goes

ईदृशेन क्रमेणैव यत्र कुत्रापि चिन्तना। शून्ये कुड्ये परे पात्रे स्वयं लीना वरप्रदा

īdṛśena krameṇaiva yatra kutrāpi cintanā | śūnye kuḍye pare pātre svayaṃ līnā varapradā

by just such course — wherever the thought goes:
void, wall, on the supreme, on the vessel,
self dissolved — the boon-giving one.

Enter Wherever Thought Goes

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.33 · V.33

Boredom is just thought's wandering — so enter there.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The dhāraṇā notices thought goes ANYWHERE — void, wall, vessel — and answers: enter there too. The blankness is not a failure of practice but a location like any other, and the giver dissolves there (svayaṃ līnā varapradā). Flatness is a door precisely because thought has already opened it.

HOW TO USE IT

When the mind goes blank or bored: don't fight it — enter the blank. Attention INTO the fog. Feeling-tip: the fog is a place; the dissolving happens by arrival, not effort.

Source: vbt-p04.md · v.33

All as Bhairava

यद् अवेद्यं यद् अग्राह्यं यच् छून्यं यद् अभावगम्। तत् सर्वम् भैरवम् भाव्यं तदन्ते बोधसम्भवः

yad avedyaṃ yad agrāhyaṃ yac chūnyaṃ yad abhāvagam | tat sarvam bhairavam bhāvyaṃ tadante bodhasambhavaḥ

whatever unknowable, whatever ungraspable, whatever void,
whatever gone to nonbeing: that all as bhairava to be contemplated —
at that end, awakening arises.

All as Bhairava

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.127 · V.127

The unmotivated state handed to Bhairava: the flat becomes the icon.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse hands you everything that refuses contact — the unknowable, ungraspable, void, nonbeing — and gives one instruction: treat it ALL as Bhairava. Boredom and blankness fall under 'whatever void': the flat is not the absence of the divine but its hardest-to-recognise shape, and tadante bodhasambhavaḥ — at that end, awakening arises.

HOW TO USE IT

When nothing is happening inside: name the nothing 'Bhairava' once. The flat becomes the icon. Feeling-tip: nothing changes except its status — and status was the only problem.

Source: vbt-p13.md · v.127

Neither Pain Nor Joy

न चित्तं निक्षिपेद् दुःखे न सुखे वा परिक्षिपेत् । भैरवि ज्ञायतां मध्ये किं तत्त्वम् अवशिष्यते

na cittaṃ nikṣiped duḥkhe na sukhe vā parikṣipet | bhairavi jñāyatāṃ madhye kiṃ tattvam avaśiṣyate

let the mind not be cast into pain, nor scattered into joy:
o bhairavī — let it be known — what reality remains in the middle?

Neither Pain Nor Joy

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.103 · V.103

The middle zone where neither pain nor joy holds the mind.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The dhāraṇā places the mind in NEITHER — not pain, not joy, not scattered — and asks Bhairavī for what remains there. The flat middle is exactly the unpainted stretch this verse works in: reality shows when no weather is present. The 'what remains' is a genuine question with a tactile answer.

HOW TO USE IT

In the neutral zone — nothing wrong, nothing good: say it and hold the mind in the middle, refusing both. Feeling-tip: the flatness becomes deliberate, a chosen neither; reality shows as the remainder.

Source: vbt-p11.md · v.103



X

Gratitude

thanksgiving & praise

Satisfied with the Three Worlds

सदा स्रिष्टविनोदाय सदा स्थितिसुखासिने / सदा त्रिभुवनाहारतृप्ताय स्वामिने नमः

sadā srṣṭivinodāya sadā sthitisukhāsine / sadā tribhuvanāhāratṛptāya svāmine namaḥ

to the master who ever delights in creation, ever sits at ease in preservation, ever is satisfied with the three worlds as food — namas.

Satisfied with the Three Worlds

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 20.9 · 20.9

One bow, five acts, and the universe as his plate.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

One salutation contains the five acts: creation as delight (vinoda), preservation as ease (sukhāsina), dissolution as the three worlds eaten (tribhuvanāhāra-tṛpta) — with grace hidden in 'delight' and 'ease'. If the three worlds are his food, your plate is a course from his meal.

HOW TO USE IT

Say it before eating, after the offering verse: his meal and yours are one table. The five acts run in the background while you chew. Feeling-tip: eating becomes cosmic maintenance — light, unhurried, slightly celebratory.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 20.9

The Sweet Festival

अहो को ऽपि जयत्य् एष स्वादुः पूजामहोत्सवः / यतो ऽमृतरसास्वादम् अश्रूण्य् अपि ददत्य् अलम्

aho ko 'pi jayaty eṣa svāduḥ pūjāmahotsavaḥ / yato 'mṛtarasāsvādam aśrūṇy api dadaty alam

oho! how wonderful — this unique festival of your worship, so sweet, gladdening all round: by it even tears come to taste the nectar.

The Sweet Festival

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 17.1 · 17.1

The pūjā as festival: even tears taste nectar.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse calls the worship a pūjā-mahotsava, a great festival, svādu, sweet — and makes a precise claim: by its amṛta-rasa-āsvādana, even tears (aśrūṇi) are given the nectar's taste. Sadness is not excluded from the celebration; it is recruited. The festival runs on whatever the day supplies.

HOW TO USE IT

On a good day: name it the festival — you're inside it. On a day that brings tears: the verse promises they taste of nectar; let them. Feeling-tip: joy and grief on the same tongue — that doubleness is the mahotsava, not a bug in it.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 17.1

Tasteless Without Your Foot-Nectar

अप्य् उपार्जितम् अहं त्रिषु लोकेष्व्
अधिपत्यम् अमरेश्वर मन्ये / नीरसं तद्
अखिलं भवदङ्घ्रिस्पर्शनामृतरसेन विहीनम्

apy upārjitam ahaṃ triṣu lokeṣv adhipatyam amareśvara manye / nīrasaṃ tad akhilaṃ
bhavadaṅghrisparśanāmṛtarasena vihīnam

if i have won the lordship of the three worlds —
all of it is tasteless, god of gods,
without the nectar of your foot's touch.

Tasteless Without Your Foot-Nectar

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 4.23 · 4.23

Three-world empire, worthless without the foot-nectar — gratitude as accounting.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse prices everything: tri-loka-adhipatya, sovereignty over the three worlds, is nīrasa — tasteless — unless bhavadaṅghri-sparśa-rasa, the nectar of the foot's touch, is present. Gratitude here is not politeness but valuation: one touch outweighs every possession. Thankfulness is correct arithmetic.

HOW TO USE IT

When something good arrives — or nothing does: say it and re-price. Without the touch, all of it is flavourless anyway. Feeling-tip: the wanting of things quiets because the math is done; the touch is the only item with a price.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 4.23

The Auspicious Fire

नमो

निकृत्तनिःशोषत्रैलोक्यविगलद्वसा- /

वसेकविषमायापि मङ्गलाय

शिवाग्नये

namo nikṛttaniḥśoṣatrailokyavigaladvasā- / vasekaviṣamāyāpi maṅgalāya śivāgnaye

bow to the auspicious fire of śiva — severing,
drying to the root, even the venom
of the three worlds' congealed flow.

The Auspicious Fire

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 2.5 · 2.5

Thanksgiving that includes the burning: the fire is praised too.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Gratitude that thanks only for sweetness is half done. Namas goes to maṅgalāya śivāgnaye — the auspicious FIRE: nikṛtta, niḥśoṣa, cut and dried to the root, and even the venom (viṣa) of the three worlds' congealed outflow. What dried the poison is also praised: the cutting was the curing.

HOW TO USE IT

Give thanks for the hard things too — say it over the fire-place of the chest. Feeling-tip: gratitude with heat; the hand on the sternum; the severing included in the thanks.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 2.5



XI

Evening / Sleep

wind down · lights out

From Your Waking, His Waking

त्वत्प्रबोधात् प्रबोधोऽस्य त्वन्निद्रातो लयोऽस्य यत्। अतस्त्वदात्मकं सर्वं विश्व सदसदात्मकम्

tvatprabodhāt prabodho'sya tvannidrāto layo'sya yat | atastvadātmakaṃ sarvaṃ viśva sadasadātmakam

from your waking comes his waking; from your sleep comes his merging. hence all is of your nature — the world, both real and unreal.

From Your Waking, His Waking

MAHOPADEŚAVIṂŚATIKĀ V.11 · V.11

Your sleep does not stop the world — it feeds it.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Two transfers: prabodha (waking) passes from you to him, laya (dissolution) from his sleep to the world. Because his waking enlivens the world and his sleep dissolves it, everything is tvad-ātmaka, of your nature. Sleep is not the end of practice but its most global act: when you sleep you participate in his laya.

HOW TO USE IT

Last line of the day. Lie down and take one awake minute: you are about to do what he does at night. Don't stay awake doing this — fall asleep inside the thought. Feeling-tip: as the eyes close, feel the day's edges get soft, 'unreal' — that softening is sadasadātmakam. If anxious at night, this dissolves the day rather than reviewing it.

Source: L2-mpa-p02.md · v.11

In Sleep, When the Outer Range Perished

अनागतायां निद्रायाम् प्रणष्टे बाह्यगोचरे। सावस्था मनसा गम्या परा देवी प्रकाशते

anāgatāyāṃ nidrāyām praṇaṣṭe bāhyagocare | sāvasthā manasā gamyā parā devī prakāśate

in the not-yet-come sleep, when the outer range has perished — that state, to be gone to by mind, the supreme goddess shines forth.

In Sleep, When the Outer Range Perished

VIJÑĀNA BHAIRAVA V.75 · V.75

The instruction for the moment before sleep: go there by mind.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Three conditions: sleep that has not yet arrived; once the outer field has died. In that gap, to be gone to by mind, parā devī, the supreme Goddess, shines — not is-made. The verse locates practice in the dying of the outer senses, where consciousness is neither awake nor asleep, and names what appears there as Śakti herself.

HOW TO USE IT

At lights-out, on your back, one hand on the belly. Wait for the outer field to fade — sounds go dull, images slow. Then instead of following sleep passively, send the mind as an arrow to the heart-centre, once. Then release. The Goddess-feel is a hum or warmth behind the chest; if images swarm you have grasped — release and let the hum carry. Single-shot: no repetitions.

Source: vbt-p08.md · v.75

At Your Cool Feet

अशेषविषयाशून्यश्रीसमाश्लेषसुस्थितः / शयीयम् इव शीताङ्घ्रिकुशेशययुगे कदा

aśeṣaviṣayāśūnyaśrīsamāśleṣasusthitaḥ / śayīyam iva śītāṅghrikuśeśayayuge kadā

when will i lie down — free of every object, settled in the embrace of undiminished glory — at your two cool lotus feet?

At Your Cool Feet

UTPALADEVA, ŚIVASTOTRĀVALĪ 9.14 · 9.14

The sleep prayer: the cool feet are the peace after the fever of wanting.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Utpaladeva asks when he will lie down free of every object (aśeṣaviṣaya — no grasping left), settled in undiminished glory (aśūnya śrī), at the two cool lotus feet (śītāṅghri-kuśeśaya). 'Free of every object' is not blankness but the rest that remains when the mind stops reaching. The cool feet are the peace of Śiva.

HOW TO USE IT

In bed. Say it once, then let the image of the two cool feet form under the mind's eye — no details needed, just the coolness. The feeling to find: the fever of the day dropping. If the mind races, return to the coolness, not the words.

Source: sivastotravali_corpus.json · 9.14

Bliss Is the Forgotten Treasure

आनन्दो ऽत्र न वित्तमध्यमदवन् नैवाङ्गनासङ्गवत्
दीपार्केन्दुकृतप्रभाप्रकरवन् नैव प्रकाशोदयः । हर्षः
संभृतभेदमुक्तिसुखभूर् भारावतारोपमः सर्वाद्वैतपदस्य
विस्मृतनिधेः प्राप्तिः प्रकाशोदयः

ānando 'tra na vittamadhyamadavan naivāṅganāsaṅgavat dīpārkendukṛtaprabhāprakaravan naiva prakāśodayaḥ | harṣaḥ saṃbhṛtabhedamuktisukhabhūr bhārāvatāropamaḥ sarvādvaitapadasya vismṛtanidheḥ prāptiḥ prakāśodayaḥ

bliss here is not wealth-middle-intoxication, nor like enjoying women, nor lamp-sun-moon-made splendour-multitude — and not the light-rise either. joy with gathered-difference-liberation-bliss-ground, like burden-lowering, is the attainment of the forgotten treasure of the all-nonduality state — the light-rise.

Bliss Is the Forgotten Treasure

ABHINAVAGUPTA, ANUTTARĀṢṬIKĀ V.4 · ANU-P04 V.4

The sleep verse: bliss as burden-lowering, the forgotten treasure.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

The verse defines bliss by negation — not wealth-drunkenness, not sensual pleasure, not spectacle-light — then gives the positive: harṣa like bhārāvatāra, the lowering of a burden, is the prāpti of vismṛta-nidhi, the forgotten treasure of the non-dual state. Falling into sleep is that burden-lowering: the day's weight set down at the door.

HOW TO USE IT

In bed, say it and feel the day's weight as the literal bhāra being lowered. Bliss here is not an event but an unloading. Feeling-tip: the shoulders drop a centimetre deeper each line; by the last line the bed has the treasure under it.

Source: anuttarastika.md · anu-p04 v.4

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

The day, complete From the first light to the last breath, the day is one sequence of recognitions: you wake into his waking, wash a body that is his temple, walk out among his forms, work as his yoke, eat his offering, wait in his pace, meet your negatives as his play, rejoice in his victory, and hand the night back to his sleep. The prayers are small; the day is the practice.

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